

Manifest file associated with the app, which defines things like theme colours and app icons.

- A couple of new packages were added to your *package.json*.
- *index.html* was updated to include references to the Web Manifest, set a default theme colour and specify a simple operative message to display if the user's browser can't run JavaScript.
- Several default icons of varying resolutions were added to the project. These are the familiar Angular shield logos — be sure to replace them with your actual website's icon design before going into production.
- Your bootstrapped AppModule was modified to import the *ServiceWorkerModule*, which registers the service worker that does all the heavy lifting to make the app a PWA.
- You got a new file at the root of

the project called *ngsw-config.json*, which, as its name indicates, is a configuration file for the Angular service worker. This configuration file allows you to define things like what static assets and data URLs (for example, the response from an API call) you'd like to be cached, and how.

If you try to run your application locally using *ng serve*, you won't notice any PWA features. Angular service workers are enabled only on production builds; so in order to test these changes locally, you'll need another strategy to serve your build. One option is to use something like the *npm* package HTTP-server, and point it to the *dist/* folder. When it's running, you should see a fully-functional PWA.

However, if you were to open up a port to your new local Web server and try to visit it from another computer, the service worker will no longer work for you. This is because service

workers will only work over the HTTPS protocol or on *localhost*, for development purposes.

One great benefit of a PWA-enabled application is its ability to check for and install updates in the background, thanks to the Web Manifest file. However, the updates can't be applied until the application tab is refreshed, or the user closes all tabs the application is running in and reopens an application tab. It may be prudent to include an instructional message to the user when a new update has been applied.

We've only just scratched the surface of what PWAs are and what service workers can do for your Angular app. There's a lot more that can be explored. **END** 🐧

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